CHAPTER 54

END OF AN ERA

27–31 July 2023

ENGLAND vs AUSTRALIA, 5th Test, *The Oval*, *London*

England 283 and 395; Australia 295 and 334

England won by 49 runs

Australia 2nd innings: **S Broad 20.4–4–62–2**; Last wicket **A Carey c Bairstow b Broad 28**

7–9 March 2024

INDIA vs ENGLAND, 5th Test, *H Pradesh CA Stadium, Dharamshala*

England 218 and 195; India 477

India won by an innings and 64 runs

India 1st innings: **J Anderson 16–2–60–2**

India 1st innings**: K Yadav c Foakes b Anderson 30** (700th Test wicket)

Broady is the last of the old generation to go – retiring after the 2023 Ashes. It's a breathless series, the closest Ashes contest there has been for years, one that spins into all kinds of moralistic storylines and rhetoric over 'Bazball' and reaches fever pitch when Jonny Bairstow is stumped by Alex Carey, walking out of his crease thinking it's the end of the over. Just like Cooky, Broady plays his last Test at The Oval, with an ending he couldn't have written better if he'd tried.

A six with the last ball he faces, a wicket with the last ball he bowls, winning an Ashes Test for England for the last time and squaring the series. It's one of the most awe-inspiring, heroic things I've ever seen, complete